

JIAXI LI

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EDUCATION

University of Georgia

Ph.D. Student in Computer Science
Advisor: Prof. Ninghao Liu and Prof. Jin Lu

Georgia, USA
Aug. 2024 - now

Shandong University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Technology

Shandong, China
Sep. 2020 – Jun. 2024

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS AND PRE-PRINTS

(*Equal Contribution, †Corresponding Author.)

[1] Mitigating Hallucination Through Theory-Consistent Symmetric Multimodal Preference Optimization

Wenqi Liu, Xuemeng Song†, **Jiayi Li**, Yinwei Wei, Na Zheng, Jianhua Yin, Liqiang Nie

Published in *NeurIPS 2025* (The Thirty-Ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems).

[2] MITS: Enhanced Tree Search Reasoning for LLMs via Pointwise Mutual Information

Jiayi Li, Yucheng Shi, Xiao Huang, Jin Lu, Ninghao Liu

Published in *PAKDD 2026 (Best Paper Finalist Award; Oral Presentation)* (The 30th Pacific-Asia Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining).

[3] HELENE: Hessian Layer-wise Clipping and Gradient Annealing for Accelerating Fine-tuning LLM with Zeroth-order Optimization

Jiayi Li*, Huaqin Zhao*, Yi Pan, Shizhe Liang, Xiaofeng Yang, Fei Dou, Tianming Liu, Jin Lu

Published in *EMNLP 2025 Main Conference* (The 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing Main Conference).

[4] Automating Expert-Level Medical Reasoning Evaluation of Large Language Models

Shuang Zhou*, Wenya Xie*, **Jiayi Li***, Zaifu Zhan, ..., Yucheng Shi, Ninghao Liu, Zirui Liu, Rui Zhang

Published in *npj Digital Medicine, 2025*.

[5] Online Skill Learning for Web Agents via State-Grounded Dynamic Retrieval

Jiayi Li, Ke Deng, Yun Wang, Jingyuan Huang, Yucheng Shi, Qiaoyu Tan, Jin Lu, Ninghao Liu

In Submission.

[6] Building Graph Memory for LLM Agents: A Data-Centric Perspective

Jiayi Li, Yuanfu Sun, Qiaoyu Tan, Jin Lu, Ninghao Liu

In Submission.

[7] Fact or Guesswork? Evaluating Large Language Models' Medical Knowledge with Structured One-Hop Judgments

Jiayi Li, Yiwei Wang, Kai Zhang, Yujun Cai, Bryan Hooi, Nanyun Peng, Kai-Wei Chang, Jin Lu

In Submission.

[8] GraphVerse: A Comprehensive Visual Graph Reasoning Benchmark for Multimodal Large Language Models

Yuanfu Sun, Yuanhang Ren, Kang Li, Chuanhao Ji, **Jiayi Li**, Jiajin Liu, Ninghao Liu, Qiaoyu Tan

In Submission.

[9] Proximal Federated Learning for Body Mass Index Monitoring using Commodity WiFi

Jiayi Li, Kiran Davuluri, Khairul Mottakin, Zheng Song, Fei Dou, Jin Lu

Published in *ICASSO@MobiCom 2024* (ICASSO Workshop of the 30th Annual International Conference on Mobile Computing and Networking).

HONORS AND AWARDS

University of Georgia Student Research Award

2026

Outstanding Graduate (B.E.)
Academic Scholarship (B.E.)

2024
2021,2022,2023

SERVICES

Regular Reviewer for Conferences ICLR, NeurIPS, ACL Rolling Review (ARR; including conferences such as ACL, EMNLP, and NAACL), KDD.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, PyTorch, C/C++, Shell Scripting, MySQL.

Infrastructure for Large Language Models (LLMs): verl, vLLM, SGLang, rllm, TRL, Ollama.

Infrastructure for Machine Learning (ML): Linux, Git, Docker, Slurm, Distributed Training Framework (DeepSpeed, Ray, Accelerate).